Written Assignment #3: Media Guide Outline

Rollins College Baseball - 2026 Media Guide

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Introduction

Rollins College Baseball enters the 2026 season looking to build on its standing as one of the more competitive programs in the Sunshine State Conference. Located in Winter Park, Florida, they are just minutes from downtown Orlando. The Tars play their home games at Alfond Stadium and draw from a roster mixing in-state talent with recruits from around the country. As a program built on strong pitching, disciplined fundamentals, and a devoted coaching staff, this has kept Rollins baseball in the postseason conversation in recent years. The Tars have no shortage of storylines heading into this year with a mix of key returners, a promising incoming class, and a loaded schedule with SSC rivalries.

This media guide is designed to serve as the single reference point for everyone who follows the program: this includes the reporters and broadcasters covering Sunshine State Conference baseball and the fans/alumni who have supported Rollins baseball throughout the years. This guide brings together the roster, statistics, records, and history that make up the identity of Rollins baseball, along with institutional and campus information that helps a recruit picture what life at Rollins looks like. Given the department's publications budget this year, the guide is built to fit within 48 printed pages.

Table of Contents

Section	Pages	Page Number
Front Cover	1	page 1
Inside Front Cover - Sponsor Advertisement	1	page 2
Table of Contents	1	page 3
Quick Facts Page	1	page 4
2026 Schedule (opponent, date, site, time, streaming)	1	page 5
Season Prospectus & Head Coach's Preview	2	pages 6-7
Head Coach Biography	1	page 8
Assistant Coaches & Support Staff Bios	1	page 9
Alphabetical & Numerical Rosters	1	page 10
Pronunciation Guide	1	page 11
Player Profiles (position players & pitchers)	16	pages 12-27
Newcomers / Incoming Class Information	2	pages 28-29
2025-26 Season in Review (results & final team/individual stats)	3	pages 30-32
All-Time Series Records vs. SSC & Regular Opponents	1	page 33
Rollins Baseball History & Program Timeline	2	pages 34-35

Honors & Awards (All-American, All-SSC, Academic All-District)	2	pages 36-37
Team & Individual Records (season, career, single game)	3	pages 38-40
Players in the Pros / Notable Alumni	1	page 41
Alfond Stadium Facility Information & Diagram	1	page 42
Sunshine State Conference & NCAA Division II Overview	1	page 43
Rollins College Overview (academics, Winter Park/Orlando)	2	pages 44-45
Media Information (credentials, contacts, policies)	1	page 46
Sponsor Advertisement Page	1	page 47
Back Cover	1	page 48

Section-by-Section Explanation

Front Pages: 1-4

- **Front cover, page 1:** a single action photograph of Rollins's top returning player, shot by a student or staff photographer, along with the Rollins Baseball logo and the 2026 season year. This is the one page in the guide that gets full color, since it is the first impression a recruit, a parent, or a conference media contact will have of the program.
- **Inside front cover, page 2:** a paid advertisement from a local sponsor, such as a Winter Park business or a Rollins booster group. Advertising is one of the main ways a small program's sports information office bolsters a limited publications budget, so this page is necessary.
- **Table of contents, page 3:** the full section listing with page numbers, placed early so a reporter working on deadline can find what they need without reading through the whole guide.
- **Quick facts, page 4:** one condensed page with the school's name, location, enrollment, colors, nickname, conference, home field, head coach and career record, last season's finish, and sports information office contact details.

Schedule, Season Outlook, and Coaching Staff: 5-9

- **2026 schedule, page 5:** the complete conference and non-conference schedule with opponent, date, site, first pitch time, and streaming information. Rollins does not have a television contract the way a Division I program might, so streaming links through the Sunshine State Conference's online platform are available for fans.
- **Season prospectus and coach's preview, pages 6 and 7:** a short overview of last year's finish, the players lost and returning, and quotes from the head coach on the upcoming season
- **Head coach biography, page 8:** career coaching record, notable achievements, and a head shot. This functions as a recruiting tool since families want to know who will be coaching their son.
- **Assistant coaches and support staff, page 9:** shortened bios for the assistant coaches, athletic trainer, and strength staff on a single shared page.

Rosters and Player Content: 10-29

- **Alphabetical and numerical rosters, page 10:** name, height, weight, position, class, hometown, and high school for every player on the roster, in a presentable manner.
- **Pronunciation guide, page 11:** a phonetic spelling for all player names to avoid mispronunciation on a conference broadcast. This is necessary for anyone doing radio or streaming play-by-play.
- **Player profiles, pages 12 through 27:** pages covering every player on the roster, with two players per page. This includes a photo, a short bio, hometown and high school information, and season statistics for each. The space allotted for this will help cover a roster of roughly thirty players within the given budget.
- **Newcomers and incoming class, pages 28 and 29:** separate write-ups for incoming freshmen and transfers highlighting recruiting-related content about each of them.

Season Review, History, and Records: 30-40

- **2025 season in review, pages 30 through 32:** final results from every game along with team and individual statistical leaders from last season.
- **All-time series records, page 33:** a table or chart showing Rollins's overall record against its Sunshine State Conference opponents and regular non-conference opponents.
- **Program history, pages 34 and 35:** a short, comprehensive history of Rollins baseball covering conference titles, NCAA tournament appearances, and other notable seasons.
- **Honors and awards, pages 36 and 37:** a listing of All-American, All-Conference, and Academic All-District honors, along with team awards going back several seasons.
- **Team and individual records, pages 38 through 40:** season, career, and single-game records for hitting, pitching, and fielding, which is a statistical reference many reporters utilize during a game.

Alumni, Facility, and Institutional Information: 41-45

- **Players in the pros, page 41:** a page on any Rollins alumni currently playing professionally or working in baseball, which will have a lot of recruiting value.
- **Alfond Stadium facility information, page 42:** a basic field diagram along with capacity and amenities, useful for media logistics and as a recruiting visual.
- **Conference and division overview, page 43:** a short explanation on the Sunshine State Conference and NCAA Division II. This is for media or recruits who are less familiar with Division II athletics.
- **Rollins College overview, pages 44 and 45:** information on academics and the Winter Park and Orlando area. This is the kind of institutional information as important for recruits and parents evaluating a smaller college.

Media Services and Back Matter: 46-48

- **Media information, page 46:** required details for working media such as credential and press box procedures, parking, interview request policy, and sports information office contact information.
- **Sponsor advertisement, page 47:** a second paid ad page to help offset printing costs.

- **Back cover, page 48:** a full-color team photo or conference championship image, similar to the front cover.

Budget, Printing, and Production Notes

There are a number of production decisions directly in the SID's hands and these include: written content, photography, advertising, page design, and the printing contract. At a program the size of Rollins, these decisions are shaped by a limited publications budget.

- **Color and printing:** the front and back covers are the only full-color pages. Every interior page is in black text with black-and-white images, which keeps the per-page printing cost down and is consistent with the one-color restriction. The print run itself goes to a regional print shop, rather than a large specialty sports publisher, given the program's size.
- **Advertising:** two paid pages, the inside front cover and page 47, are built in specifically to offset printing costs. The advertising rate for those pages is based on per-page production cost, and any ad copy would be proofread by the sports information office before it goes to print.
- **Photography and art:** player head shots and action photographs are shot by a student photographer or a department staff photographer rather than a hired studio. The images are kept on file afterward so they can be reused in future guides, game programs, or media requests for historical photos.
- **Game-day programs:** separate from the media guide, the sports information office is also responsible for the game-day program sold at home games. For a smaller varsity sport like baseball at Rollins college, this takes the form of a simple roster flip card with a player feature, rather than a full printed program.

Production Schedule

Since Rollins opens its season in early February, the schedule below targets a mid-January delivery date, with the file going to the printer roughly three weeks before that.

- **Late fall:** update the record book, season-in-review section, and program history from the completed prior season, and finalize the head coach's biography.
- **Early December:** finalize the roster with incoming signees, schedule and shoot player photos, and write the newcomer introductions.
- **Late December:** present all written copies to the head coach and staff for factual review, alongside finalizing any advertising sales.
- **Early January:** complete a full check of grammar, statistics, factual accuracy, and approve the final layout.
- **Mid-January:** send the file to the printer, allowing about three weeks for printing and delivery ahead of the season opener.